

agility in this space. Of these, 267 have been finalised and the rest are in various stages of approval.

EIPs are of various types such as standard track, core, networking, interface, ERC, meta and informational.

The significant number of proposals and rapid finalisation workflow indicate a thriving community working towards standardising the interactions in blockchain (at least in the Ethereum world), thus building the momentum for developing standard libraries across routine functions.

Smart contract libraries

Smart contract libraries are nothing but contracts. However, their purpose is to be deployed once at a specific address and then be reused for delegating routine tasks, so that the calling functions can execute as if this is their own code as part of the contract.

There are two kinds of smart contract libraries — reusable behaviours that one can add to contracts, and implementations of various standards.

Common routine coding patterns include exception handling or managing unexpected issues. Smart contract libraries usually provide reusable implementation of the behaviours as

libraries or via inheritance in Solidity (a language in which smart contracts can be developed).

Open Zeppelin contract library is a GitHub project dedicated to secure smart contract development with a role based permissioning scheme for the development and use of reusable Solidity components. This is a very popular forum used in building complex decentralised systems. An innovative and interactive ‘Contracts Wizard’ approach is available to get started with generating smart contracts. The contracts support stable APIs, ensuring unexpected upgrade related issues are addressed efficiently.

Dappsys is another popular collection of smart contracts building blocks. It’s written in Solidity but can be linked to any language (think of it as smart embedded APIs). DS-Math is the most used library for arithmetic functions that does basic addition, subtraction, multiplication and division by handling integer overflows and simplifying routine functions like finding the minimum or maximum of two numbers.

The rapid adoption of blockchain and smart contracts is pushing the development community to get a common standard. This is still a work in progress, though. **END** 

References

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August 2022	Cloud Special: Everything from management to implementation
September 2022	Mobile/Web App Development, Optimisation and Security
October 2022	Blockchain and Open Source
November 2022	Open Source and IoT and Edge
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February 2023	Open Source on Windows and Best in the world of Open Source (Tools and Services)